

# I Was a 'Good' Developer, So Why Did I Quit Coding to Design?

A quiet journey from algorithms to empathy. From solving logic puzzles to solving human problems. This is why I made the switch, and why you might want to, too.

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*I didn't wake up one day and decide, "I want to be a designer."*

It was quieter than that. Slower. Almost accidental.

## <> The Developer Years

Back in college, I was deep in Java, crushing hackathons, grinding leetcode, even ranking 14th globally in IEEE Xtreme. I loved solving logic puzzles. The thrill of a clean algorithm? Unbeatable.

So I became a developer "on paper." Moved to JavaScript, HTML, CSS. Built React and Next.js apps. Took on client work. Delivered. Got paid.

But something felt... off.

## The Disconnect

It wasn't the bugs. Or deadlines. It was the disconnect.

### The Signup Button

I'd spend hours optimizing a backend API, only to realize users never got past the signup form because the "Continue" button blended into the background.

### The Loading State

I'd refactor a component for performance, and my teammate would ask, "But why does it feel slower now?" (Turns out: no loading feedback.)

Even with ChatGPT writing half my boilerplate, I wasn't excited anymore. **I missed caring.**

I tried DevOps, thinking maybe infrastructure was the spark. Nope. Servers don't sigh in frustration when they can't find a menu.



Then a friend said, casually: "Have you ever tried UI/UX?"

## The Moment Everything Changed

I opened Figma that night. Drew a button. Animated its hover state. Built a fake onboarding flow, just to see how it felt to tap through it.

And for the first time in years,  
**I forgot to check the time.**

### That's when it hit me:

I wasn't avoiding coding.

I was avoiding building things that didn't matter to people.

## Every Decision Has a Why

In UI/UX, every decision has a why tied to a human:

### Why is this icon confusing?

Understanding user mental models

### Why do they hesitate here?

Identifying friction points

### Why does this animation make them smile?

Creating moments of delight

**That's the work I wanted.**

## Where I Am Now

Now, at Savart, I'm not just "designing screens." I'm helping shape how thousands of users experience financial planning through thoughtful UI, intentional motion, and interfaces that don't just work, but respect attention, time, and trust.



### Thoughtful UI

Every element serves a purpose



### Intentional Motion

Animations that guide and delight



### Respect & Trust

Interfaces that honor user attention

No hype. No "disrupting the industry." Just real problems, real users, and the quiet joy of making something clearer.

## So If You're...



**A developer who keeps tweaking the UI after the feature's "done"**



**Someone who notices bad forms, confusing menus, or janky transitions, and can't unsee them**



**Curious about design but think, "I'm not 'creative' enough"**

**...you're not behind.**

**You're just early.**

The best designers I know didn't start with sketchbooks.

They started with questions.

With frustration.

**With the stubborn belief that it could be better.**

**That's where this journey begins, not with tools or trends, but with care.**

## Ready to Start Your Journey?

I'm running a small masterclass soon, no sales pitch upfront.

Just real talk, real projects, and the kind of learning that sticks because it's yours.

**Join the Masterclass →**

Limited spots available

If any of this resonated, even a little, I'd love to have you.

P.S.

*My first Figma file was called "test\_v3\_FINAL\_really\_final.fig". We've all been there.*

## Ready to Make the Switch?

Join a community of developers who are discovering the joy of design.

**Reserve Your Spot →**

Limited to 20 participants • Starts soon

**K S Sai Teja**

Design Technologist @ Savart

Building interfaces that respect attention, time, and trust.